

is independent of the general system wide account privilege level. GitLab application accounts are of the "Development" account type. To further differentiate within the "Development" account type there are privileged and non-privileged accounts. ((AC-2(a), AC-2(7)). Roles associated with tokens:

| Role | Privilege state |

| ---- | ----- |

| Site Administrator | Privileged |

| Developers | Both privileged and non-privileged, depending on specific roles |

| Group Owner | Privileged |

| Group Maintainer | Privileged |

| Project Owner | Privileged |

| Project Maintainer | Privileged |

| Group Developer | Non-privileged |

| Group Reporter | Non-privileged |

| Group Guest | Non-privileged |

| Project Developer | Non-privileged |

| Project Reporter | Non-privileged |

| Project Guest | Non-privileged |

1. All assignments of the Group Owner, Group Maintainer, Project Owner, Project Maintainer roles must be limited, documented, and approved by the Site Administrator (AC-2(i), AC-5, IA-4).

1. All Impersonation tokens must be approved by the Site Administrator (AC-5).

1. All Group and Project membership must be approved by the respective Group and Project Owners (AC-5). All existing Group and Project memberships will be reviewed semiannually, and membership that is no longer appropriate will be removed (AC-2(j), AC-2(7)).

1. All registered Runners will be reviewed semiannually, and any unnecessary instances will be removed.

1. Group and Project Maintainer and Owner roles assume and share the responsibilities of "Account Managers" for their respective Groups or Projects including but not limited to token approval, creation, revocation, usage monitoring (AC-2(b)(e)(f)(g)). These roles are identified here as they can create tokens at the Group and Project level. This is essentially account creation as the creation of a token is also the creation of the associated bot account.

1. All Group, Project, Runner Registration, and Deploy tokens must be approved by an Account Manager. (AC-2(c)(d)(e))

1. To allow for the possibility of small teams and personnel having two roles, but still maintain a level of process integrity, account managers should enlist other account managers for token creation and reporting. An Account Manager may not approve their own token (AC-5).

1. A log or inventory of active tokens will be maintained by Account Managers for each group. (This will be a heavy administrative lift for large teams that issue many tokens.)

1. Account Managers will review token usage and revoke any unnecessary or unused tokens at least monthly (AC-2(j), AC-2(3)).

1. Account Managers will revoke any token reported as compromised by the token holder (AC-2(12)).

1. GitLab supervisors/GitLab customers will notify all Group owners of employment status changes that may require adjustment in rights and permissions (AC-2(h)).

1. Group and project tokens will be revoked when a member leaves the group or project for termination or reassignment (AC-2(h)).

1. Storage of tokens outside the GitLab environment must have suitable protection at a level equal to or greater than the Group or Project the token provides access to (IA-5(6)).

Token Creation and Distribution

1. Sharing and distribution of tokens will be limited, and must include documentation, and identity verification of who the token is being distributed to (IA-5(a)).
1. GitLab team members will not distribute tokens to non-team members (AC-21, AC-22).
1. Token names will include the Group/Project name, and the creation date (YYYYMMDD) (IA-2, IA-5(b)).
1. Tokens will be created with the minimum role and scope necessary to perform the desired task(s) (AC-6).
1. Tokens will never be created with the Maintainer or Owner role (AC-6).
1. Tokens will be created with the shortest reasonable expiration time to accomplish the desired task, but in all cases shall have expiration date not to exceed: (AC-2(3))
 - Personal Access Tokens - 30 days
 - Group Tokens · 1 year
 - Project Tokens · 1 year
 - Deploy tokens · 72 hours
 - Deploy keys · 72 hours
 - Impersonation Tokens · 24 hours
 - Runner Tokens · 1 year
 - Runner Registration Keys · 72 hours
1. The "random" part of a token (excluding prefixes and other additions) will be generated using a FIPS-certified and cryptographically-approved algorithm.

Token Storage

1. Storage of a token must be secure. It needs to be encrypted. Recommended methods include usage of a security vault or a key management system. For cloud or self-managed environments this can include Hashicorp Vaults Pro, Amazon KMS or Google Secret Manager. For local (e.g. laptop) storage, encryption is still required, using a password manager is recommended (e.g. 1Password). Copies or backups of tokens must NOT be stored in configuration files, text files, and other plaintext storage methods.

Token Compromises

1. Compromised tokens must be mitigated immediately. As compromised tokens can lead to various dangers such as disclosure of sensitive data, unauthorized access, and even privilege escalation in some cases, any compromise must be taken seriously. At GitLab the standard is for immediate revocation of the token followed by an investigation to assess potential impact. It is understood that immediate revocation of a compromised token may break existing access and automation. This impact is typically much smaller than the risk associated with a valid token being used by a malicious actor. As it is possible to automate some of the detection methods to assist in detecting a compromised token, these automated detection methods should also include the capability to automate the revocation as well.
1. All methods, procedures, notifications, and automations for mitigating a compromised token need to be fully documented. At GitLab any changes to any processes need to be approved by the Security Department, specifically SIRT. Major changes to gitlab.com (e.g. potential impact to production) need to be communicated in advance to all relevant parties.
1. GitLab will revoke any tokens identified as leaked to protect user accounts. After revocation, the token owner will receive an automatic notification informing them that their

token has been revoked.

Token Logging and Auditing

1. The lifecycle of a token (creation, attributes, usage, and deletion) must be logged for auditing purposes.
1. The logging of token activities can be stored "locally" in limited quantities, but backup/offsite storage is recommended.
1. With logging, the token value itself must remain hidden or masked to prevent token compromise.

Token Use

1. Any code developed to use tokens must include documentation which contains the following:
 - A methodology for the periodic replacement of the token.
 - The required scope (permissions) for a replacement token.
 - Identify what task the token is intended to perform (application, process, function call name).
1. Token use must be logged by the code triggering the token authentication (AC-6(9)). Log events will include at a minimum:
 - Successful or unsuccessful token authentication.
 - What object, process or function the token accessed.
 - Any changes performed by the token.
 - Data access, changes or deletions performed by the token.
 - Date and time.
 - The object, function or process that utilized the token.
 - What account activated the token usage.
1. GitLab team members given possession of tokens will maintain control and protection of those tokens and notify Account Managers if it is believed that a token is corrupted or has been compromised in some way.
1. Production and development environments require the use of different tokens. Tokens will not be shared between environments.

Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy will be tracked as per the Information Security Policy Exception Management Process and currently, potential exceptions need the permission of Security Assurance.

References

- Controlled Document Procedure

The references (e.g. "AC-2(a)") are detailed in NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5.

The role of "administrator" or "site administrator" implies the main responsible overseer of the GitLab instance. Within GitLab SaaS this is known as the Owner. In a self-managed instance and Dedicated this is the Admin.

Developer implies coding, but any "developers" of projects that require tokens for various

automation purposes are considered "developers" in this context.

SECTION: security/threat-management/_index.md

Security Threat Management Sub-Department

The Security Threat Management sub-department is responsible for identifying and remediating vulnerabilities or threats that may impact GitLab, our Team Members or our Customers and the community at large.

Security Threat Management Mission

The Security Threat Management sub-department's mission is to support the business and our overall security efforts by ensuring that we are focused on real world threats and vulnerabilities that impact us. We accomplish this by:

- working closely with engineering, product, infrastructure, and other security department teams
- designing and deploying vulnerability and threat management processes
- conducting in-depth security related research and assessments
- transparently communicating important information externally to customers and the community alike

Teams

The Security Threat Management sub-department includes the following teams. Learn more about each by visiting their Handbook pages.

- Security Identity Engineering leads the technical strategy and automation implementation of next-generation identity and access management (IAM), role-based access control (RBAC), and administrative access controls for internal GitLab systems, cloud infrastructure, and tech stack applications.

SECTION: security/threat-management/identity/_index.md

Overview

The Security Identity Engineering team was formed on 2023-12-01 to lead the design and implementation of our next-generation of identity and access management framework and program at GitLab that we refer to as Identity v3. The founding members of the team joined Security from the IT Engineering and IT Infrastructure team as part of an organization realignment, however have been working on identity management projects for several years.

To get started with understanding the Identity function, see the Identity handbook page. Our flagship project is the Identity Platform, powered by Access Control (accessctl) and Access Check (accesschk).

The team is just getting started, so please see the Identity Engineering Issue Tracker to learn more about what we're working on.

Looking for IT Infrastructure? Please create an issue in the Identity Ops Issue Tracker or ask in Slack security-identity-ops.

Looking to get access to something? Please open an access request using the appropriate issue template.

Quick Reference

Contact Us

- (Preferred) Ask in security-identity-ops
- Tag us in an existing issue with @gitlab-com/gl-security/identity/ops
- Tag us in an existing Slack thread with @security-identity
- Create an issue in Identity Ops Issue Tracker
- Confidential? Send a Slack DM to one of the team members.

On Call Schedule (Slack DM)

- Use Slack DM on weekdays. Use PagerDuty on weekends.
- 00:00 to 03:00 UTC - Jeff Martin
- 03:00 to 07:00 UTC - No Coverage (contact SIRT)
- 07:00 to 15:00 UTC - Vlad Stoianovici
- 15:00 to 17:00 UTC - Jeff Martin / Vlad Stoianovici (sunset handoff)
- 17:00 to 23:59 UTC - Jeff Martin

Epics and Issues

- Operations
 - Access Requests Issue Tracker (use issue template)
 - Identity Ops Issue Tracker (day-to-day requests)
- Engineering
 - Identity Engineering Epics Roadmap
 - Identity Engineering Epics
 - Identity Engineering Issue Tracker (leadership sponsored or OKR related)
 - Access Control Public Issue Tracker (features and bugs for our software and tools)
 - Access Check Public Issue Tracker (features and bugs for our software and tools)

Data Sources

- Identity Policy and Manifest Data
- Identity Kingdoms and Tech Stack
- Counterpart Directory

Projects and Source Code

- Open Source Projects at gitlab.com/gitlab-identity
- Internal Projects at gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gl-security/identity

Team Directory

<!-- STARTTEAMDIRECTORY -->

yaml

smanzuik:

name: 'Steve Manzuik'
pronunciation: 'man-zoo-ick'
title: 'directorthreatvulnerabilitymanagement'
emailhandle: 'smanzuik'
gitlabsaashandle: 'smanzuik'
timezone: 'US Pacific (UTC-8 Winter/UTC-7 Summer)'
workinghours:
 pt: '7:00am to 4:00pm'
 utcwinter: '15:00 to 23:59'
 utcspring: '16:00 to 00:59'
oncallhours: null
links:
 gitlabsaasprofile: 'https://gitlab.com/smanzuik'

martin:

name: 'Jeff Martin'
pronunciation: 'bat-man'
title: 'staffsecurityengineer'
emailhandle: 'jmartin'
gitlabsaashandle: 'jeffersonmartin'
timezone: 'US Pacific (UTC-8 Winter/UTC-7 Summer)'
workinghours:
 pt: '7:00am to 4:00pm'
 utcwinter: '15:00 to 23:59'
 utcspring: '16:00 to 00:59'
oncallhours:
 pt: '5:00am to 7:00pm'
 utcwinter: '12:00 to 03:00'
 utcspring: '13:00 to 04:00'
links:
 gitlabsaasprofile: 'https://gitlab.com/jeffersonmartin'

vstoianovici:

name: 'Vlad Stoianovici'
pronunciation: 'stoy-on-oh-vitch'
title: 'seniorsecurityengineer'
emailhandle: 'vstoianovici'
gitlabsaashandle: 'vlad'
timezone: 'Eastern Europe (UTC+2 Winter/UTC+3 Summer)'
workinghours:
 eet: '9:00am to 7:00pm'
 utcwinter: '07:00 to 17:00'
 utcspring: '08:00 to 18:00'
oncallhours:
 eet: '9:00am to 7:00pm'
 utcwinter: '07:00 to 17:00'
 utcspring: '08:00 to 18:00'

links:

gitlabsaasprofile: 'https://gitlab.com/vlad'

<!-- ENDTEAMDIRECTORY -->

SECTION: solutions-architects/_index.md

Solutions Architecture Mission

Mission Statement:

"As a learning organization, we enable our customers to realize value as they achieve outcomes faster and more efficiently and drive GitLab sales through technical and business consultation."

Elaboration:

Leveraging our technical and domain-specific expertise, along with strong cross-functional collaboration, Solutions Architects strive to become trusted advisors, fostering a collaborative learning environment with our prospects, customers, partners, and internal teams. Our primary objectives include:

- Crafting impactful value propositions that resonate with prospects, demonstrating the potential for transformative outcomes through GitLab adoption.
- Championing successful adoption of the GitLab platform, ensuring our customers realize maximum value from their investment.
- Cultivating a thriving business partner ecosystem by fostering partner capabilities and co-developing innovative solutions that expand market reach and customer value.

Here's how the SA organization fosters value creation through the lens of a learning organization and DevOps culture:

1. Shared Vision & Value Creation

- The SA team aligns its goals with the overarching organizational vision of empowering customer success.
- They prioritize customer value creation, understanding that their success is directly tied to the positive outcomes achieved by their customers.
- This shared focus encourages collaboration and a sense of collective responsibility towards delivering value.

2. Personal Mastery & DevOps Expertise

- SAs continually expand their technical, consultative, and domain-specific knowledge, embracing a mindset of lifelong learning.
- They actively seek out new information, experiment with innovative solutions, deliberately practice, and share insights with their peers, contributing to the team's collective expertise.
- This emphasis on personal mastery aligns with the DevOps culture of continuous improvement and adapting to evolving technology landscapes.

3. Systems Thinking & Customer-Centric Approach

- SAs take a holistic view of the customer's challenges, understanding how different parts of their organization and technology stack interact and impact each other.
- They identify potential bottlenecks or inefficiencies, working collaboratively to design solutions that optimize the entire system for maximum value creation.
- This systems thinking approach echoes the DevOps philosophy of breaking down silos and promoting cross-functional collaboration to achieve shared goals.
- SAs also leverage these concepts to improve internal processes at GitLab.

4. Challenging Established Mental Models & Encouraging Innovation of Thought

- SAs encourage customers to question assumptions and challenge traditional ways of thinking about their processes and technologies.
- They introduce new perspectives and innovative solutions, helping customers overcome limitations and unlock new opportunities for growth.
- This focus on challenging existing mental models and fostering innovation reflects the DevOps principle of experimentation and learning from both successes and failures. SAs also challenge internal assumptions and approaches, looking to continuously improve GitLab's ability to help our customers.

5. Teamwork & Knowledge Sharing

- The SA team operates as a collaborative unit, sharing knowledge, experiences, and best practices freely.
- They create a safe space for experimentation and learning, fostering an environment where individuals feel comfortable asking questions, seeking help, and offering insights.
- This emphasis on teamwork and knowledge sharing reflects the core DevOps values of collaboration and transparency.

6. Building and leveraging continuous feedback loops

- The SA organization thrives on feedback, both between team members and through instrumentation of our practices. By leveraging feedback and data, the SA organization makes data driven decisions wherever possible.
- A culture of feedback reflects the DevOps philosophy of continuous improvement and adapting to evolving technology landscapes.

Conclusion:

By embracing the principles of a learning organization the SA team becomes a powerful catalyst for customer value realization. They not only provide technical expertise but also foster a collaborative and innovative environment where customers are empowered to achieve their goals and maximize the value they derive from GitLab solutions.

Role & Responsibilities

Solutions Architects (Field)

Field Solutions Architects (SA) are the trusted advisors to GitLab prospects and customers during the presales motion. We demonstrate how the GitLab platform and GitLab Professional Services address common and unique business requirements. SA's add value to GitLab's customers by providing subject matter expertise and industry experience throughout the sales process and collaborate internally with product.

In addition, SA's identify and propose comprehensive solutions to complex business problems and workflow scenarios after compiling inputs from customer requests during conversations. Desired inputs include pain points, role-based visibility concerns, opportunities for improved efficiencies, current technologies and tools (3rd party to GitLab) and therefore opportunities to improve integrations, corporate initiatives, target outcomes and more. SA's also act as the technical liaison between the sales team and other groups within GitLab, engaging GitLab employees from other teams as needed in order meet the needs of the customer.

Our Field SA's also engage proactively with existing GitLab customer to provide thought-leadership, engage in innovative solutions, collaborate around evangelism activities around unique customer requirements (i.e. meetups and presentations) and continuously seek market feedback to improve the GitLab platform.

Center of Excellence

The Solutions Architecture Center of Excellence is team comprised of Subject Matter Experts, Demo Architects, and Business Value Managers focused on accelerating GitLab's market leadership and revenue growth by delivering specialized expertise at scale.

Strategic Field Organization

The Strategic Field Organization is a team of Principal Solutions Architects that support global strategic sales opportunities and customers. This team collaborates with the regional account teams to work together on large engagements that require a higher degree of strategic planning, consulting, executive-level technical leadership, and internal GitLab cross-departmental collaboration.

Ecosystem Solutions Architects

Ecosystem Solutions Architects are the trusted advisors to our strategic alliances partners, professional services partners, and channel resellers. The focus of this team is to develop relationships and provide technical assistance and leadership to drive joint GTM strategies. This team helps grow and strengthen the partner ecosystem by building new capabilities and growing GitLab revenue together with partners.

In addition to core responsibilities, Solutions Architects may assist in other client-facing activities aligned to Partner and Strategic Marketing such as blogs, videos, webinars, presentations and industry trade show presence.

See the Solutions Architect role description for additional details, and Engaging an Ecosystem SA when you need help with a partner cooperative opportunity.

SA Managers

- SA Manager Process

The Field and Partner SA Management (referred as SA management going forward) around the globe collaborates around unique requirements, identifies improvements in the go-to-market approaches and focussed on prioritises on strategies to address the market's requirements. The SA management is aligned in the interest of technical matters to address exisiting needs raised by

customers and prioritize on innovative requirements. The SA management will collaborate with product teams to achieve required outcomes.

Trusted Advisors

Being a Trusted Advisor is referencing a role/skill that a person takes on when working with customers to solve their business problem.

> Building Trust (Trusted Advisor):

> Connects with key stakeholders on both a personal and professional level and shows up as a credible and reliable champion for customers. Effectively positions GitLab as a partner to the customer rather than just another vendor with a focus on following through on commitments and delivering results.

>

> --<cite> Solution Focus Field Competency

Key Attributes for Positioning Value

As the DRIs helping position, prepare, and guide a customer's technical evaluation the SA team ensure that GitLab can surface the right points of value to the customer's key stakeholders post technical evaluation. The following embody GitLab's technical evaluation philosophy and help guide successful technical evaluations.

These offerings are delivered each within a specific context of a particular customer journey.

- Labs / Workshops: Closed invite, typically in-person events (or a Zoom meetings) providing an exclusive list of customers (typically 1) access to a lab environment, where SAs provide personalized guidance to the customers as questions arise to help them see the value of what they are not currently paying for.

- Technical Discovery: A deep dive into current practices at the company that aid in helping identify pain points specific to where GitLab can help address needs and work towards a better long-term state.

- Demonstrations: Built around the work done within the technical discovery. Demonstrations aim to address at least 3 specific pain points identified during discovery while selling the vision of GitLab's DevSecOps platform approach.

- Guided Trials: Three goals in 30 days through the usage of a GitLab Trial. This can oftentimes be used to replace the need for the more formal Proof of Value.

- Proofs of Value: Technical evaluation with more complexities than a Guided Trial. May last up to 8 weeks.

Changing the Solutions Architects Handbook Content

This is the Solution Architect handbook. If you see any typos, copywriting improvements or content clarifications you'd like to contribute, please create a merge request and ask your managers to merge. Please add the label "SA-HANDBOOK" to your merge request, and post a link to the solutions-architects slack channel, mentioning @saleaders, as a heads up and so we can thank you! Since we have a bias for action, we trust your judgement.

SECTION: solutions-architects/demonstrations.md

Demo Systems Overview and Specific Environments

The Demo Systems Handbook page provides an overview of the demo system infrastructure used for demonstrating GitLab features, value propositions, and workflows.

See the Environments sub-page for specific details on how to access the environments for use in your demos.

Demo Readiness

Solutions Architects are occasionally called on at a moments notice to give a demo or join a call to show a prospect or customer specific GitLab functionality. A best practice for being prepared for these demo requests is to have a minimized browser window with various content preloaded into the browser tabs. Examples of common environments utilized are listed below. Note that accessing some of these links are only enabled for GitLab team-members. (To-do: port this list to the demo catalog)

- The GitLab Demo Systems provides a catalog of demos and the sandbox infrastructure for performing demos.
- The GitLab.org Group level clearly represents GitLab Epics, Roadmaps and cross-project issue views used for planning releases
- A GitLab.com project driven by Auto DevOps which includes a populated issue board as well as an active Merge Request is highly useful for describing value of workflow utilizing GitLab Auto DevOps for build, test, security and review
- This GitLab.com project is commonly utilized specifically for security discussions
- The production monitoring for GitLab.com is useful for any discussion regarding custom and in-app monitoring
- The production Grafana instance showing GitLab Runner details is a great way to represent the art of the possible as it relates to monitoring and dashboards
- The GitLab Direction page in the Handbook is often beneficial for future-looking product vision questions and discussions about upcoming features
- Optional: Integrations may be loaded and ready to discuss by leveraging the standard demo environments
- Other Existing demo groups and projects are listed in the next section

Repeatable process for maintenance of recording GitLab Flow-style demos

Back in FY23-Q1 we've started an OKR to create a repeatable process for maintenance of recording GitLab P2M-style demos, which, in turn, resulted in a followup OKR in FY23-Q3 to Document the repeatable process for maintenance of recording GitLab Flow-style demos.

Setup the demo and environment

All GitLab assets are available in this group, refer to the README for more information on how to Get Started.

GitLab Flow-scenario

We should have a short presentation that acts as an intro and guides our viewers through the demo. This presentation (located in the CS->Demo Script folder in GDrive) could be used as a base for this.

The main flow should be:

- Introduction to the One GitLab Platform
- Highlight of a select number of added capabilities and their value (if possible say thank you to the release MVP)
- Demo of GitLab Flow

Existing Demonstrations

Demo Architect Offerings Handbook page lists currently available shared CS demos, lunch & learns and workshops maintained and owned by Demo Engineering.

In addition, there are various legacy sources and locations that might be helpful in locating reusable demos and projects:

- Demo Catalog Project
- GitLab Examples are used by product groups for feature validation, speed runs, demos, and feature showcasing in docs. The GitLab CI/CD Examples documentation points our customers to these for their own use as well.
- Guided Explorations - has projects for a variety of topics, from language-specific feature flag examples, various DevOps patterns, pipeline tips, tricks, and hacks for windows, and more.
- GitLab CS Tools - group that provides projects for GitLab cs automation and migration tools
- Customer Success Demos - centralized location for demos used by Customer Success, including a set of golden repos for different application types, security demos, and more.

Slide Decks for SA Demos

There are several slide decks stored on google drive that are commonly used for demos. Feel free to make a copy of any of these to personalize for your own needs.

- All the Things - contains a comprehensive set of slides on all GitLab functionality and value propositions
- General Demo.pptx - Product walkthrough deck created and maintained by Cherry Han. Tip: you can make a copy of the deck, then open the deck in Google slides to edit it for your own purposes.
- Demo Prep

<details><summary>Here is the Demo Preparation Roadmap which details the steps to undertake/consider to leverage the Demo2Win strategies before delivering a demo.</summary>

<image>

<iframe src="https://drive.google.com/file/d/1KloJZ0Lcm83gUHA5nzIFpgQ784xMHZp/preview" width="640" height="480" allow="autoplay"></iframe>

</image>

SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-career-development.md

Career Development

Solutions Architecture team members you should review the GitLab People Group Career Development page for the roles, responsibilities, and helpful career development resources.

Solution Architecture Specific Career Development

Career Paths

Because of the valuable experience and skills gained while driving customer outcomes, Solutions Architects can move to a variety of technical, sales and leadership roles in GitLab and across industries.

The diagram below can help you exploring potential evolutions of your career development.

<iframe style="border: 1px solid rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.1);" width="800" height="450" src="https://www.figma.com/embed?embedhost=share&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.figma.com%2Fboard%2FGbJpPTw3NOG9%2FSA-Career-Path%3Fnode-id%3D0-1%26t%3D3bKqHgWXxzLX3oSk-1" allowfullscreen></iframe>

While maturing a decision or assessing options, the below steps can help you throughout the process:

1. Have a career development conversation with your manager to discuss the learning opportunity. It's important to:

- Discuss the Career Path you want to explore and your motivation
- Learn about what involves to be in these roles (for instance, you can read the job description for the roles you are interested in or speak directly with people who are in these roles)
- Draft an Individual Growth Plan where you highlight:
 - Options you are looking to explore
 - Gaps you might see with where you are now in your development compared you want to be
 - Timing
 - Explore existing and future job openings in GitLab

2. If the career move you are looking to do is in GitLab but outside of your current team, discuss with your manager to speak to the DRI for the job opening you are looking to potentially apply for

3. Before speaking to the DRI, draft a clear set of questions you want to ask, based on job description and any doubts/questions you have from chatting with others already in the role

4. Schedule a coffee chat or start a slack DM with the DRI of the job opening

5. Discuss with your manager the outcome of these conversations and your decision

6. If you are ready to apply, go ahead and apply for the role. Good Luck with your application!

Promotion Process

The Solutions Architecture promotion process augments the People Group Promotion Process with the following:

1. The Planning stage of the calibration process here typically means the SA leaders have forecasted the promotion candidates at least 2 quarters ahead of the promotion cycle.
1. For Staff and Principal level promotions, the promotion justification document must be completed 2 quarters prior to promotion date and submitted to the VP of SA for review.
1. For Staff and Principal level promotions, the promotion candidate's manager will consult with the SA leadership team, typically during a weekly team meeting. This is to ensure continuous calibration for Staff and above-level roles that have lower representation amongst the SA organization. This must occur 2 quarters before the expected promotion quarter. For example, for a Q1 promotion, the calibration should occur in Q3 of the prior FY.
1. For Staff level promotions, the promotion candidate's manager will consult with existing Staff and Principal level SAs for peer-level review and feedback while taking detailed notes to be reviewed with SA leadership.
1. For Principal level promotions, the Principal candidates will prepare and present their accomplishments and their vision for improving GitLab and the SA organization to a panel of SA leaders and Principal level SAs after the review with SA leadership (2 quarters prior to the promotion cycle). This happens before the standard promotion cycle calibrations.
1. The Principal promotion panel will then meet to discuss the candidate's suitability for the Principal SA role.
1. After reviewing and providing feedback, the VP of Solutions Architecture will inform the Manager or Director of his/her approval.
1. At this point, the standard quarterly promotion process is followed

Associate Solution Architecture Program

In FY23, GitLab kicked off its first ever Associate Program across Customer Success with the aim to:

- Build the next generation of highly-diverse, well-prepared GitLab Solutions Architects
- Grow pre-sales engineering skill sets that are focused on GitLab's product offering, business model and aligned to customer needs
- Give existing SAs an opportunity to grow in their careers through having early-in-career SAs to mentor and coach

The program leverages the enablement material that all SAs use in the onboarding process in addition

to providing team members earlier in their careers content that instills a passion for a single DevOps Platform built on open source.

The program helps build technical, trusted advisory muscle memory, places team members in a role serving the SMB segment, and in a function where there is high awareness of priorities that are aligned to visible results.

Supplemental Onboarding Content

The Associate SA Program aims to embody as many GitLab values as possible as it aims to instill a passion for DevOps, Open-Source Software, and GitLab. Key values and sub-values include:

- Dogfooding (Results Sub-value)
- Self-service and self-learning (Efficiency Sub-value)
- Be a mentor (Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Sub-Value)
- Iteration
- Transparency

The content is supplemental to the 30/60/90 day onboarding that all SAs go through.

Activity / Content	Timeline / Frequency	Description
----- ----- -----		
End of Week Debrief	Weekly from Week 1	The SA Manager overseeing the Associate SA Cohort will setup an end of week debrief for 30 minutes where the cohort can ask questions and provide feedback on the week thus far. This time is also used to review and provide synchronous feedback on any assignments that were due throughout the week. Please note that any synchronous feedback should be secondary as the preferred way of relating feedback to individuals is asynchronous
Call Review	Bi-Weekly, first 3 months	Upon receiving access to Chorus, the cohort ought to review a single call at least every other week
Getting Good with Troops	For 4 weeks at the 3-4 months mark	Associate SAs should plan to attend at least 3 calls per week and record these calls via Troops
GitLab Exercise	The goal of this activity is to become comfortable with GitLab mechanisms for educating oneself about the wider GitLab initiatives throughout the organization	
Capability Deep Dives	Weekly upon Completion of Demo2Win These weekly capability deep dives aim to solidify good Tell-Show-Tell practices. These ought to continue until SAs begin doing demos with customers.	
SA-to-AE Coffee Chats	As the cohort becomes comfortable with demoing and taking the lead on calls, it is important to begin establishing relationships with the Account Executives they will support.	
Associate SA Reference Materials	Associate SAs can refer to examples of demos leveraging Demo2win strategies along with the slide deck, as well as other supplemental materials.	

Cohort Coaches

Coaches meet with the entire cohort for either a specific session or multiple sessions.

Americas May Cohort

Coaches	Frequency	Description
----- ----- -----		
Taylor Medlin	Weekly	
Joe Randazzo		
Noah Ing	One-time	Kubernetes
Jan Kunzmann		Observability 101

|

Cohort Mentors

Coaches meet with the entire cohort for either a specific session or multiple sessions.

Americas May Mentors

Mentor	Associate SA	
-----	-----	
Taylor Medlin	Jerez Solis	
Sarah Bailey	Sophia Manicor	
Corina Patachia	Christian Nnachi	

How to Get Engaged with the Program

If you are looking to coach or mentor Associate SAs that are going through the program you can do so by helping the Associate SAs understand the value of different GitLab categories within our stages. Upon completion of Demo2Win, every week, the team is assigned a new Category to learn about and show the value of that category through the tell-show-tell methodology. Sign up for updates by including your GitLab username as a CC recipient to the Weekly Capability Deep Dive issue template which is used to determine the weekly category.

Additionally, the team is finalizing a mentoring program that is slated to begin in Q3 of FY23.

If you are looking to be considered for the Associate SA Program, look at our Job Board for any Associate SA postings.

Recognition

Recognizing the hard work that the Solutions Architects bring to the sales process and to GitLab itself is something we hold dear. The SA organization should feel proud of the wins they achieve. Whether they are business related or personal goals reached, SA's deserve to be called out for their accomplishments.

Peer Recognition

Recognizing (and being recognized) by your peers is extremely fulfilling. If an SA is recognized by a peer, it may appear in one or more of these places:

- The thanks Slack Channel (Used by the entire organization for all manner of appreciation.)
- The deal-gratitude Slack Channel (Used primarily by the Field Organization for recognizing work on sales deals.)
- The wins-key-deals Slack Channel (When an SA is associated with a high profile win, they are automatically added to the details of the win within this channel. SA Leadership is working with Sales Ops to bring more attention to this notification.)
- Various team meetings (At the start of most SA calls, there is a devoted section for expressing gratitude and appreciation.)
- Discretionary Bonuses (If an SA has gone above and beyond and truly lived up to GitLab's

CREDIT values, a discretionary bonus of \$1000 US can be awarded. These nominations can come from anyone in the company and at any time.)

Management Recognition

At various points of the year, SA's have the opportunity to be recognized by their managers and/or Customer Success leadership.

- Field Organization Quarterly Achievers (12 various winners from across the Field Organization for outstanding performance in the Quarter. A designated chat with the CEO, CRO and the other winners as well as a \$250 US expensed dinner are included)
- President's Club (13 members of the SA organization (and their optional guests) from across the globe are selected based on contributions throughout the year. More on the selection criteria can be found in the internal link)

SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-content.md

Introduction

The purpose of this effort is to consistently create content that:

- Helps customers be successful in an async manner
- Supports our GTM efforts by scaling the solutions architecture knowledge and reach
- Builds thought leadership across the solutions architecture community
- Enables solutions architects to spend more time having meaningful conversations with customers

This is not meant to limit creativity. It's a boring solution to systematically and consistently create content beneficial to our customers.

Content process

1. Sign up as an author by adding your username to the calendar table next to the publish date of your choice. Multiple people are welcomed and encouraged to post during the same week.
2. Choose a topic from the demo wishlist(internal only) or framework tutorials(internal only) list. Add the topic to the calendar table next to your username and publish date. Feel free to bring your own topic!
3. Create your video or blog post. Please store all code examples in the Guided Explorations group to share with customers.
4. If creating a video, please add your video to the Solutions Architecture GitLab Unfiltered Playlist.

Blog post generator

For easy creation of a blog post and all the items behind the scenes, use the blog post creator.

FY24 Q2 Calendar

Publish Week	Author	Topic	Content Type
-----	-----	-----	-----
2023-05-08	Noah Ing & Sophia Manicor	Managing Multiple Environments with Terraform and GitLab CI	Blog
2023-05-15	Sam Morris	Getting started with your first Docker app + container registry and scanning	Blog
2023-05-22	Jeremy Wagner	How To Deploy NextJS to Vercel	Blog
2023-05-29	Cailey Pawlowski		
2023-06-05	Julie Byrne	How GitLab can help you with your SOC2 audit	Blog
2023-06-12	Julie Byrne	Preparing for a Migration to GitLab.com	Blog
2023-06-19	Michael Balzer		Blog
2023-06-26	Jeremy Wagner & Sophia Manicor	React + Cypress Tests	Blog
2023-07-03	Joe Randazzo		
2023-07-10	Siddharth Mathur		
2023-07-17			
2023-07-24			

Example Blogs & Videos

Here is a list of example posts and videos to serve as an inspiration for getting started. You do not need to add your post to the list once you're finished.

Publish Date	Author	Topic	Content Type
-----	-----	-----	-----
2022-01-27	Sarah Bailey	All About The Merge Request	Video
2022-08-02	Madou Coulibaly and Joe Randazzo	How to provision dynamic review environments using merge requests and Argo CD	Blog
2022-09-23	Joe Randazzo	CI/CD Modernization with GitLab	Video
2022-10-06	Jeremy Wagner	How to automate testing for a React application with GitLab	Blog
2023-01-03	Joe Randazzo and Noah Ing	Keeping Your Development DRY	Blog
2023-01-09	Julie Byrne	Migrating from Self-Managed to SaaS	Video
2023-02-06	Siddharth Mathur	Setting Up OIDC to Get Credentials from Google Cloud	Video
2023-03-01	Jeremy Wagner	How to Deploy React to Amazon S3	Blog
2023-03-06	Siddharth Mathur	Automating Deployments to ECS with GitLab CI/CD	Video
2023-03-13	Noah Ing and Sam Morris	Actioning Security Vulnerabilities	

in GitLab Premium	Blog		
2023-03-15 Julie Byrne			Getting Started
with GitLab Application Security	Blog		
2023-03-21 Siddharth Mathur			How to
automate a Twitter bot using GitLab CI/CD			Blog

DRI rotation

Every quarter, the DRI for maintaining the calendar will rotate. The main responsibility of the DRI is finding volunteers to fill the calendar to ensure consistent content creation and to identify the next DRI.

FY24 Q2 DRI: Jeremy Wagner

FY24 Q3 DRI: Open to volunteers

How to contribute

Everyone can contribute. This effort was started to combine multiple initiatives to get content to help customers. Have an idea? Submit an MR and improve the process.

Some easy ways to contribute to this effort are:

1. Volunteer for a spot on the calendar
2. Volunteer to be the DRI for a quarter
3. Adding requested demos to the 5 minute demo wishlist
4. Add frameworks to the frameworks tutorial list
5. Expand the deployment options for various cloud providers
6. Identify the best way to share content with the GTM team so they are aware to share with customers

SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-documentation.md

Purpose

The overarching purpose is to ensure that solutions that are built with GitLab have a place in GitLab's documentation to assist with discovery and endorsement of such solutions as being recognized and in some cases actively maintained by GitLab.

Official GitLab documentation is managed with regard to industry standard excellence in software product documentation. In this regard the official documentation:

- is scoped to focus only on official features in GitLab itself.
- follows specific structures for pages.
- how to tutorial content generally stays focused on small feature set scenarios as they tend to be a function of documenting the same features.

In the past, solution oriented items have also been published in GitLab's blog. The Solutions

documentation area differs from blogs in the following ways:

- Blog articles are edited for brevity, where solutions are edited to ensure specific features and functions are shown to work, regardless of length.
- Blog articles are known by the reader to age and become less accurate over time, where solutions documented items are intended to be maintained in a working state.
- Blog articles becomes harder to find in searches as they age, where solutions should continue to be relatively easy to find.

The creation of the Solutions documentation section allows the documentation of solutions, which are best formulated in ways that are generally broader than product documentation in some of these ways:

- can focus on features in partner products that integrate with GitLab
- can focus on solutions that may leverage features from many parts of GitLab and in combination with non-GitLab technologies.

The solutions area is under complete stewardship of the SA team and are not actively reviewed by Tech Writing. The solutions documentation section will strive to meet the excellence bar set by GitLab tech writing. All contributors are encouraged to take the GitLab Internal Tech Writing Course.

Content scope

While the solutions area is more flexible to account for solution oriented assets, it must also be fresh and accurate. A content freshness review process is identified below. Additionally, this content scope helps ensure more volatile information is not stored as documentation as it generally leads to editorial overwhelm.

Content Example	In or Out of Scope	Notes
-----	-----	
Solutions Indexes that point to solutions inside and outside of GitLab.	In Scope	
Cloud integration resources - where there may be many points of integrations authored by both companies.	In Scope	
Detailed step-by-step tutorials and working code examples that will be maintained.	Out of Scope	
Step-by-Step tutorials stored in a GitLab project, with a single line reference to it's existence in Solutions documentation		
Working code or step-by-step tutorials that are meant to be a one-time contribution to the solution ecosystem.	Out of Scope	
Published as a blog - which carries the expectation that it was working when published, but will age with time.		

Documentation Merge Process

It is important that MRs for Solution Docs use the appropriate MR Template so that the

documentation change is not routed through the normal tech editing process and CI jobs - but through the optimized workflow of Solutions Docs instead.

1. Prepare your changes in <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab>

1. IMPORTANT: When preparing your Merge Request, use the MR Template called "Documentation SA Solutions Docs"

1. This leaves off the label ~"docs::improvement" and adds the label ~"Solutions" (which also affects which CI jobs run)

1. This adds the appropriate reviewers (which can be seen in the MR template here:

[https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab/-](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab/-/blob/master/.gitlab/mergerequesttemplates/Documentation%20SA%20Solutions%20Docs.md)

[/blob/master/.gitlab/mergerequesttemplates/Documentation%20SA%20Solutions%20Docs.md](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/gitlab/-/blob/master/.gitlab/mergerequesttemplates/Documentation%20SA%20Solutions%20Docs.md))

SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-leader-shadow.md

Overview

The SA leadership shadow program is a 2-week immersion to experience the skills required to become an SA people leader structured around the four fundamental rules of Solutions Architecture leadership, referred to as the 3+1 Rules of Sales Engineering Leadership: Manage yourself, Develop and serve your people, Run your organization as a business, and Serve and delight your customers.

Program Goals

- Experience firsthand how SA leaders embody and execute the 3+1 rules framework
- Understand leadership decision-making processes through direct observation
- Contribute to key initiatives while learning leadership principles
- Foster transparency, diversity, inclusion, and belonging
- Develop future SA leaders who can excel across all four rules

Participating in the Program

Eligibility

Candidates must:

1. Complete their Individual Growth Plan (IGP)
2. Review their IGP with their manager and discuss leadership aspirations
3. Review the SA Manager Operating Rhythm and discuss this with your manager

How to Apply

1. Create a merge request to add yourself to the rotation schedule
2. Assign your manager and ask them to approve and merge the merge request
3. Coordinate shadowing arrangements through your manager

Rotation Schedule

Start Date	Shadow Name	Geo Preference (can be multiple)	Status
-----	-----	-----	-----
FY25 Q3	arunkg	NEUR	Completed
FY26 Q1	Regnard Raquedan	AMER	Completed
FY26 Q1	Paul Dumaitre	EMEA	Scheduled
FY26 Q1	Nupur Sharma		
FY26 Q2	Julia Gätjens		
FY26 Q2	Chloe Cartron	EMEA	
FY26 Q2	Ted Gieschen	EMEA	
FY26 Q3	Hossam Hamdy	EMEA	
FY26 Q4	Ryan Taylor	AMER	
FY27 Q1			
FY27 Q2			

Program Preparation

Confidentiality

As a shadow, you'll have access to confidential information. Specifically, if you chose to shadow an SA leader outside of your Geo (AMER, APJ, EMEA), you will require compliance with the Designated Insiders process for a period of time. Even after this period is complete, the program's success depends on continually maintaining this trust beyond the duration of the shadow. If you are shadowing an SA leader in your same Geo, there is no need to be added to grow through a specific Designated Insiders process.

:bulb: NOTE: the DI review process happens quarterly and DI access lasts at least a quarter (subject to Legal Team evaluation), so the SA Shadow will be added to the DI list for an entire quarter as a minimum. To make sure everything is done in transparency and respect of rules for Gitlab and GitLab employyes, the SA Manager will need to open an SA Shadow onboarding/offboarding issue using this template. The SA Shadow onboarding/offboarding issue has to be opened a quarter in advance from the SA joining the SA Leader Shadow program.

Getting Ready for Your Shadowing Experience

Ensure you've made necessary preparations before beginning.

Take time to review your calendar and confirm you can fully commit to this development opportunity. Verify that your current workload allows for dedicated shadowing time, and arrange coverage for any essential deals under your responsibility. Before starting, have a detailed conversation with your assigned manager to get clarity on the shadowing schedule and expectations.

To provide you with diverse leadership exposure, you'll be matched with a leader outside your direct reporting line. This intentional pairing allows you to observe and learn from different management approaches and leadership styles.

The SA leader you will shadow will maximise your exposure to a diverse set of activities, however some of them may not be available during your shadowing and this is up to the shadowing SA leader discretion.

Program Focus

The shadow experience leading up to, during, and after the 2-week shadow is organized around the 3+1 rules framework:

Rule 0: Manage Yourself

- Develop SMART goals for your shadow experience
- Schedule preparatory coffee chats with SA leaders
- Create a personal leadership development plan
- Identify key areas for growth and mentorship
- Build a 30-60-90 day transition plan for potential leadership roles

Rule 1: Develop and Serve Your People

- Participate in SA 1:1 meetings
- Join hiring manager/panel interviews
- Complete Interview Training
- Practice giving feedback through ride alongs
- Learn team development and retention strategies
- Get TeamOps Certified

Rule 2: Run Your Organization as a Business

- Observe Geo SA deal review sessions
- Analyze regional performance data
- Contribute to QBR preparation and presentations
- Attend sales forecasting calls
- Study resource allocation and capacity planning
- Learn business metrics and KPIs

Rule 3: Serve and Delight Your Customers

- Shadow customer-facing leadership activities
- Learn escalation management processes
- Understand customer success metrics
- Observe strategic account planning
- Study customer satisfaction initiatives

Skills Development

| Skill | Development Activity |

|-----|-----|

| Lead by Example | Maintain account responsibilities, demonstrate proactive customer engagement |

| Team Development | Complete the TeamOps Certification, participate in team building |

| Talent Management | Complete Interview Training, and if possible, participate in the hiring process |

| Retention of Personnel | Take feedback from the Retrospective, prepare the QBR Retrospective Slide for your given team and lead the discussion on that slide, and build an initiative around

improving one aspect of the team |
Provide Feedback	Participate in customer calls and provide feedback to the SA
Communication	Participate in leadership meetings where appropriate, participate in note-taking
Sales Strategy	Engage in forecasting and strategy sessions
Mentorship	Mentor another SA
Personal Development	Identify key areas of growth and work with a mentor on growing areas in monthly cadenced meetings

Suggested Reading

- Amp It Up
- Creativity Inc
- Crucial Conversations
- Empathy: Why it matters
- Give and Take
- Hidden Potential
- High Output Management
- How To Win Friends and Influence People
- Leaders Eat Last
- Multipliers
- Necessary Endings
- Radical Candor
- Team Topologies
- The Art of Leadership
- The Challenger Sale
- The Chimp Paradox
- The Culture Map
- The Five Dysfunctions of a Team
- The Ideal Team Player
- The Leader Lab: Core Skills to Become a Great Manager, Faster
- The Leader Who Had No Title
- The Making of a Manager
- The Qualified Sales Leader
- The Sales Engineering Manager's Handbook
- The Speed of Trust
- The Tao of Coaching
- Think Again
- Tribes

Share Your Leadership Journey: Have you read a book, article, or resource that significantly influenced your development as a leader? We welcome your contributions - please submit an MR to add your transformative reading recommendations to this page.

Other Shadow Programs

- CEO Shadow Program
- CFO Shadow Program

SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-onboarding.md

View the SA Handbook homepage for additional SA-related handbook pages.

{{% alert title=".." color="warning" %}}

This information is under active development and is not yet final. This page will be updated on an ongoing basis during this phase.

{{% /alert %}}

Solutions Architects Onboarding Overview

Onboarding for Solutions Architects is meant to provide newly hired Team Members with information to expedite the process of becoming acclimated to GitLab and the SA role. As a crucial part of the Solutions Architecture team, it is imperative that the new Team Member understands the intricacies of how GitLab's products and solutions work and thus be able to articulate specific use cases and efficiently execute demos.

The purpose of this role-specific onboarding program is to provide the newly hired Solutions Architect (SA) with information to expedite the process of becoming acclimated to GitLab and the SA role. As a crucial part of the Solutions Architecture team, it is imperative that as a new SA, you fully understand the intricacies of how GitLab's products and solutions work. This will enable you to articulate GitLab's Go To Market (GTM) Messaging, apply specific use cases, and efficiently execute demos.

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Introduction

Welcome to your GitLab Solutions Architects (SA) Onboarding!

We are so excited you're here and look forward to setting you up for all-remote success as your team member journey begins.

Now that you have completed your core GitLab onboarding issue housed in GitLab.com, and Sales Quick Start (SQS) it is time to jump into your role-based onboarding path. This onboarding program will cover Technical Onboarding as it relates to the SA role. An overview of topics and links covered in your role-based learning path can be found in this role-specific onboarding guide. Please make a copy of this document and check off items as you complete them.

This onboarding still adheres to the sentiments of self directed and continuous learning, using the diverse set of high and low touch resources available to all GitLab team members such as videos; handbook pages; blog pieces; Zoom sessions and knowledge assessments, while encouraging asynchronous communication and workflows.

Support and our Single Source of Truth

Since GitLab is a handbook first organization, the answer to any question you may have particularly throughout your first thirty days should be documented and readily available as this is our Single Source of Truth (SSoT).

If you are unable to find the information you are looking for, please be sure to reach out to your Manager; Onboarding Buddy; People Connect Team member or the Field Enablement team for support by tagging them in the comments section of this SA onboarding feedback issue. If you need to troubleshoot specific issues with tools, you can add a screenshot of the issue directly in the comment to help them diagnose the problem.

Alternatively once you are active on Slack, which is used solely for informal communication, you will notice that you have been automatically added to a handful of useful support channels such questions, cs-questions, solutions-architects, it-help, etc.

Learning Objectives for SA Onboarding

In addition to the SQS learning objectives, your onboarding is intended to fulfill the following learning objectives:

Module 1: SA at GitLab

- Understand the SA Mission
- Differentiate the roles and responsibilities within the SA org
- Describe what it means to be a Trusted Advisor
- Recall the GitLab Sales Learning Framework
- Illustrate how to use demo projects in the CS shared demo space
- Acquire certification in GitLab Certified Fundamentals

Module 2: SA Processes

- Demonstrate understanding of the SA process maps, activity capture, and engagement models per region
- Recall the GitLab Sales Stages
- Identify the SA's roles within the various sales stages
- Summarize the GitLab Pitch
- Describe what technical discovery is
- List the different approaches and activities to achieve a technical win
- Demonstrate understanding of the Value Stream Workshop
- Deliver a Positioning a Value Stream Workshop
- Outline the steps for building a Customer Success Plan
- Acquire certification in GitLab CI/CD Associate

Module 3: Technical Deep Dive

- Complete pre-work for Sales Quick Start (SQS)
- Recognize the customer issues prioritization framework
- Demonstrate deep understanding of DevSecOps Adoption
- Acquire certification in GitLab Certified Security Specialist

Module 4: Demo Engineering

- Demonstrate ability to utilize the GitLab Sandbox Cloud
- Demonstrate cloud readiness
- Deliver demos on various product features / functions
- Acquire certification in GitLab Certified Agile Portfolio Management Associate

Module 5: SA Practices and Selling Excellence

- Demonstrate understanding of the various SA practices including but is not limited to:
 - Proof of Value (POV)
 - Strategic Solution Selling
 - Selling professional services
 - Mutual Customer Success Plan
 - Business Value Consulting
 - Value Stream Discovery
- Describe Reference Architecture
- Install GitLab via Omnibus and via Helm Chart
- Demonstrate understanding of GitLab's competition by reviewing battlecards
- Recognize second tier competitors
- Demonstrate understanding of Professional Services at GitLab
- Explain how to submit marketing support requests for participating in in-person events

Module 6: SA Onboarding Conclusion

- Identify tools and resources available to you
- Recognize the various career paths that you can take in your career as a SA
- Identify helpful enablement resources available to you in the SA Knowledge Mine on Highspot

Milestones and Onboarding Roadmap

Expectations for Manager Support during Onboarding

Your manager will be there to support you during your onboarding journey and beyond. Beyond the expectations laid out for your manager in your onboarding issue and role-based onboarding guide, they will be providing you with the following support:

Month 1

- Schedule recurring 1:1s
- Provide guidance on who the new hire should schedule coffee chats with during their onboarding journey
- Review and discuss company policies
 - PTO policy
 - Family and Friends first culture
 - CREDIT Values
 - Growth and Development Budget
- Discuss any team specific expectations
- Review organizational structure
- Ensure new hire has access to all role-specific tools and appropriate Slack channels

- Align on a general plan to get customer ready; discuss shadowing opportunities
- Ensure new hire is meeting appropriate milestone and expectations from week to week; engage your new hire in discussions about their learnings and insights from their onboarding
- Identify skills to be mastered and resources available to accomplish learning objectives

Month 2

- Check in regularly with your new hire
 - Ask them if they are experiencing any challenges with GitLab's asynchronous culture
 - Discuss any general concerns
- Encourage new hire to continue building their internal network and provide support by facilitating introductions to key stakeholders, other team members, and cross functional teams as needed
- Share constructive feedback on their recorded demos they were expected to complete as part of their role based onboarding
- Ensure onboarding milestones are met and that new hire is completing required courses and certifications and is shadowing calls
- Align on whether your new hire is on track to be customer ready and how else you can provide support to help them prepare for customer engagement
- Discuss best practices

Month 3

- Decide on